

It is not that money doesn't matter. Who among us would not seek the resources sufficient to fully enjoy our life and liberty? We desire the security of freedom from want, the ability to pursue our chosen careers, the where-withal to educate our children, and the comfort of a secure retirement. But how much wealth do these goals require? Indeed, we ought to wonder whether the super-wealth we observe at the most extreme reaches of our society—the ability to acquire an infinite number of the things of life—is not more bane than blessing.

. . . and of Fame and Power

Fame, too, is a flawed measure of success. Yet fame, sadly, seems to be the great ego builder of our age. If only those who strive for fame would ask themselves two essential questions: From what *source*? To what *avail*? Yes, of course the momentary fame of our sports heroes and the glittering fame of our entertainers give us the joy of seeing human beings operating at the very peak of their potential. But in today's fast-paced world, much of that glow rarely lasts more than the metaphorical 15 minutes of fame that Andy Warhol promised each one of us. Fame for real accomplishment is one thing. Fame based on self-aggrandizement, fame that is ill deserved, fame that is gained through wealth extracted from our corporate and financial institutions (and investors!), and fame that is used for base purposes are entirely different matters.

I'm only human, so I must confess to having enjoyed my own occasional heady brushes with fame. Of course I was amazed and delighted when in April 2004 I opened *Time* magazine and learned that I had been included on its first annual list of "The World's 100 Most Influential People," sandwiched in the "Heroes and Icons" group with Bono, Nelson Mandela, Tiger Woods, and the Dalai Lama. I knew I hadn't been chosen for my golf swing (only fair) or my serenity (nonexistent!), and learned that creating Vanguard and the first index mutual fund landed me on the list. I much appreciated the honor.